



TOOLBOX TALK — WEEKLY SAFETY MEETING

Millwork | Carpentry | Interior Finishes | Material Handling

WEEK 04

Date: Supervisor:

Project / Job Name:

TOPIC: Lumber Storage & Stacking Safety

OVERVIEW:

Improperly stored lumber is a silent hazard. A stack of lumber that looks stable can shift without warning under changing temperature, humidity, or vibration from nearby work. Crush injuries from falling lumber are serious and frequently cause broken bones, head injuries, and fatalities.

TALKING POINTS — Read to Crew:

1. Always stack lumber on a flat, level surface. If the ground is uneven, use cribbing to level the base before you start stacking. Place dunnage — spacers — every 4 feet along the length of the stack to prevent sagging between support points. Sagging lumber creates internal stress that can cause the entire stack to shift or collapse.
2. Stack height matters. Keep lumber stacks at or below 6 feet without additional restraint. Above that height, stacks become unstable and increasingly dangerous to retrieve material from. If you must stack higher for space reasons, use additional bracing or restraint systems and talk to your supervisor before doing so.
3. Banding and strapping on lumber bundles is under tension and can fail suddenly. When a steel band breaks, it snaps with enough force to cause serious lacerations to the face and hands. Never cut strapping with a hook knife pointed toward your body. Stand to the side when cutting, wear gloves, and shield your face from the snap.
4. Long stock — studs, trim lumber, long molding — has a tendency to roll. Store long material in racks or with end stops to prevent it from rolling off a pile. Never store long stock where it overhangs a traffic area, and always secure the ends so that a bump from a cart or forklift cannot send it rolling across the floor.

DISCUSSION QUESTIONS — Ask Your Crew:

- Q1: Where are our current lumber storage areas, and are they properly set up with level ground and dunnage?
Q2: Has anyone seen a lumber stack shift or fall? What caused it?

KEY SAFETY POINTS:

- Use proper dunnage every 4 ft to support all stacked lumber
- Never stack lumber higher than 6 ft without additional bracing
- Keep lumber away from edges of elevated platforms at all times
- Inspect banding — snapped banding can whip and cause lacerations
- Store long stock so it cannot roll or shift unexpectedly

Crew sign-in sheet on page 2 — all 30 crew members sign on the following page.



CREW SIGN-IN SHEET

WEEK 04

By signing, I confirm I attended this toolbox talk and understand the topic discussed.

#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)	#	PRINT NAME	SIGNATURE (click to sign in Acrobat)
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